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MEGHA GARG
WHOLE-TIME DIRECTOR, HAPPY FORGINGS

Leads digital marketing and branding for the company

Leads ESG and sustainability initiatives, including developing frameworks and targets to reduce emissions and adopt renewable energy

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Showing up consistently, speaking to people and letting them know you're there to learn and help the business are critical to being accepted. For Megha Garg, Whole-time Director of high-precision automotive and industrial component maker Happy Forgings, things were a bit different. She entered the business as the daughter-in-law of the founder. After studying in the UK, she worked in consulting for a few years before moving back to India. When she joined her husband Ashish at the company set up by her father-in-law Paritosh Kumar Garg, it was a far cry from the world of consulting and accounting that she was used to.

"I spent time talking to all the business heads across the organisation to understand what they did and that helped me gain a deep understanding of the business, down to how an 8,000-tonne forging press works," she says. In addition to spearheading digital marketing and stakeholder communications, she has been driving the company's sustainability framework, training herself and her team on how to look at ESG and how to report it, setting a goal to reduce Scope 1 and Scope 2 carbon emissions by 50% by 2030 while expanding the use of renewable energy.

LEADING FROM THE FRONT

Very often, acceptance comes from seeing how the leader handles difficult situations. In 2023, the genset industry was going through a change in emission norms, which meant that the entire product range at Kirloskar Oil Engines had to be rejigged. Not satisfied with the pace of development, Gauri Kirloskar held a meeting of all the employees where she made two things clear. "The first was that we will remain committed to our core competence, which is energy and power, and the second was a message of 'all hands on deck' for the emission changes. I could see the